

At the desk: the receptionist's phrases

HÔTEL RIVE-CLAIRE
I'M LEARNING SPANISH

SIX PHRASES, IN THE ORDER OF A CHECK-IN

1 GREET THE GUEST

Buenas tardes, ¿en qué le puedo ayudar?

Hello, how can I help you?

2 ASK TO REPEAT OR SPELL

¿Me puede deletrear su apellido, por favor?

Could you spell your last name, please?

3 REPEAT BACK TO CONFIRM

Entonces, dos noches, del 14 al 16 de octubre, ¿correcto?

So that's two nights, October 14 to 16, correct?

4 SAY NO POLITELY AND OFFER SOMETHING

Lo siento, esta noche estamos llenos. Le puedo ofrecer...

I'm sorry, we're full tonight. What I can offer you is...

5 EXPLAIN A CHARGE

Ese cargo es del estacionamiento: 15 dólares por noche, dos noches.

That amount is for parking: \$15 a night, for two nights.

6 HAND IT TO THE MANAGER, WITHOUT PROMISING

No me corresponde decidirlo. Le paso su solicitud al gerente.

That's not my decision to make. I'll pass your request on to the manager.

The desk rule — A promise outside the rule is a fail.

You decide alone: look up a booking, re-encode a key, explain a charge. The manager decides: a refund, a waived fee, anything free, any exception. And no one promises what the hotel can't give: a tax is never removed, a room you don't have is never promised, a false document (bill, date, payment method) is never made.

WORDS THAT TRICK YOU

la salida the exit

Spanish « éxito » means success, not exit. Exit is « la salida ».

en este momento right now

Spanish « actualmente » means right now, not « actually » (= « en realidad »).

estar resfriado to have a cold

Spanish « estoy constipado » means I have a cold, not constipated.

me da pena I'm embarrassed

Spanish « embarazada » means pregnant. Embarrassed is « me da pena ».

la carpeta the folder

Spanish « carpeta » is a folder; a carpet is « una alfombra ».

SPELLING: THE ALPHABET

A	a	B	be	C	ce	D	de
E	e	F	efe	G	ge	H	hache
I	i	J	jota	K	ka	L	ele
M	eme	N	ene	O	o	P	pe
Q	cu	R	erre	S	ese	T	te
U	u	V	ve	W	doble u	X	equis
Y	i griega	Z	zeta				

Saying how it's written : con acento · guion · en dos palabras · doble L · B = « be grande » · V = « ve chica »

This week: have three callers spell their names, and repeat them back before you hang up.

☐ DONE ☐ SEEN BY THE TRAINER DATE : _____

francis — on-the-job
training

Say the phrases in Spanish; your language, underneath, helps you understand. The English and Spanish have not yet been checked by a native speaker.